

A) Politics and Society

Political and Social Life in Ancient India, Important Rulers, Places etc.

1) Prehistoric Age

1] With reference to ancient South India, Korkai, Poompuhar, and Muchiri were well known as: [2023]

- a) Capital cities
- b) Ports
- c) Centres of iron- and- steel making
- d) Shrines of Jain Tirthankaras

2] Consider the following dynasties: [2023]

- 1. Hoysala 2. Gahadavala
- 3. Kakatiya 4. Yadava

How many of the above dynasties established their kingdoms in early eighth century AD?

- a) Only one b) Only two
- c) Only three d) None

3] Consider the following pairs: [2021]

- | | |
|---------------------|------------------|
| (Historical place) | (Well-known for) |
| 1) Burzahom: | Rock-cut shrines |
| 2) Chandraketugarh: | Terracotta art |
| 3) Ganeshwar: | Copper artefacts |

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only b) 1 and 2
- c) 3 only d) 2 and 3

2) Indus Valley Civilization

4] The famous female figurine known as 'Dancing Girl', found at Mohenjo-daro, is made of: [2025]

- a) Carnelian b) Clay
- c) Bronze d) Gold

5] Which one of the following is not a Harappan site? [2019]

- a) Chanhudaro b) Kot Diji
- c) Sohgaora d) Desalpur

6] Which of the following characterizes the people of Indus civilization? [2013]

- 1. They possessed great palaces and temples.
- 2. They worshipped both male and female deities.

3. They employed horse-drawn chariots in warfare.

Select the correct statement/ statements using the codes given below.

- a) 1 and 2 only b) 2 only
- c) 1, 2, and 3 d) None is correct

7] Regarding the Indus Valley civilization, consider the following statements? [2011]

1. It was predominantly a secular civilization and the religious element, though present, did not dominate the scene.

2. During this period, cotton was used for manufacturing textiles in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2 d) Neither 1 nor 2

8] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists: [2002]

(Ancient Site)	(Archaeological Finding)
A. Lothal	1. Ploughed field
B. Kalibangan	2. Dockyard
C. Dholavira	3. Terracotta replica of plough
D. Banawali	4. An inscription comprising ten large-sized signs of the Harappan script

- | | | | | |
|----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| b) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| c) | 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| d) | 2 | 1 | 3 | 4 |

9] Which one of the following animals was NOT represented on the seals and terracotta art of the Harappan culture? [2001]

- a) Cow b) Elephant
- c) Rhinoceros d) Tiger

3) Vedic Age

10] With reference to the difference between the culture of Rigvedic Aryans and Indus Valley people, which of the following statements is/are correct? [2017]

1. Rigvedic Aryans used the coat of mail and helmet in warfare whereas the people of Indus Valley Civilization did not leave any evidence of using them.
2. Rigvedic Aryans knew gold, silver and copper whereas Indus Valley people knew only copper and iron.
3. Rigvedic Aryans had domesticated the horse whereas there is no evidence of Indus Valley people having been aware of this animal.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

11] The religion of early Vedic Aryans was primarily of: [2012]

- a) Bhakti
b) Image Worship and Yajnas
c) Worship of Nature and Yajnas
d) Worship of Nature and Bhakti

12] The “dharma” and “Rita” depict a central idea of ancient Vedic civilization of India. In this context, consider the following statements: [2011]

1. Dharma was a conception of obligations and of the discharge of one’s duties to oneself and to others.
2. Rita was the fundamental moral law governing the functioning of the universe and all it contained.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2 d) Neither 1 nor 2.

13] The term ‘Aryan’ denotes: [1999]

- a) An ethnic group b) A nomadic people
c) A speech group d) A superior race

14] In the context of ancient Indian society, which one of the following terms does not belong to the category of the other three? [1996]

- a) Kula b) Vamsa
c) Kosa d) Gotra

15] The original home of the gypsies was: [1995]

- a) Egypt b) Russia
c) India d) Persia

4) Age of Mahajanpadas

16] With reference to ancient India (600–322 BC), consider the following pairs: [2025]

Territorial region River flowing in the region

- I. Asmaka : Godavari
II. Kamboja : Vipas
III. Avanti : Mahanadi
IV. Kosala : Sarayu

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- a) Only one b) Only two
c) Only three d) All the four

17] With reference to the history of India, consider the following pairs: [2020]

- | Famous Place | Present State |
|-----------------|------------------|
| 1. Bhilsa | — Madhya Pradesh |
| 2. Dwarasamudra | — Maharashtra |
| 3. Girinagar | — Gujarat |
| 4. Sthanesvara | — Uttar Pradesh |

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 3 only b) 1 and 4 only
c) 2 and 3 only d) 2 and 4 only

18] Consider the following pairs: [2016]

- | Famous place | - | Region |
|-------------------|---|-------------|
| 1. Bodhgaya | - | Baghelkhand |
| 2. Khajuraho | - | Bundelkhand |
| 3. Shirdi | - | Vidarbha |
| 4. Nasik (Nashik) | - | Malwa |
| 5. Tirupati | - | Rayalaseema |

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- a) 1, 2 and 4 b) 2, 3, 4 and 5
c) 2 and 5 only d) 1, 3, 4 and 5

19] Which of the following Kingdoms were associated with the life of the Buddha? [2014]

1. Avanti
2. Gandhara
3. Kosala
4. Magadha

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1, 2 and 3 b) 2 and 4
c) 3 and 4 only d) 1, 3 and 4

20] Between which of the following was the ancient town of Takshasila located? [2006]

- a) Indus and Jhelum b) Jhelum and Chenab
c) Chenab and Ravi d) Ravi and Beas

21] Who among the following was not a contemporary of the other three? [2005]

- a) Bimbisara b) Gautama Buddha
c) Milinda d) Prasenjit

22] Which one of the following was initially the most powerful city-state of India in the 6th century B.C.? [1999]

- a) Gandhar b) Kamboj
c) Kashi d) Magadh

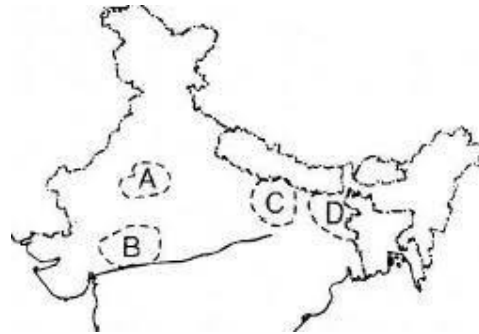
23] Which of the following pairs are correctly matched? [1998]

- I. Lothal: Ancient dockyard
II. Sarnath: First Sermon of Buddha
III. Rajgir: Lion capital of Asoka
IV. Nalanda: Great seat of Buddhist learning

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) I, II, III and IV b) III and IV
c) I, II and IV d) I and II

24] The following maps shows four of the sixteen Mahajanapadas that existed in ancient India: [1997]



The places marked A, B, C and D respectively are

- a) Matsya, Cedi, Kosala, Anga
b) Surasena, Avanti, Vatsa, Magadha
c) Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa, Anga
d) Surasena, Cedi, Kosala, Magadha

5) Mauryan Period

25] Ashokan inscriptions suggest that the 'Pradeshika', 'Rajuka' and 'Yukta' were important officers at the: [2025]

- a) village-level administration
b) district-level administration
c) provincial administration
d) level of the central administration

26] According to Kautilya's Arthashastra, which of the following are correct? [2022]

1. A person could be a slave as a result of a judicial punishment.
2. If a female slave bore her master a son, she was legally free.
3. If a son born to a female slave was fathered by her master, the son was entitled to the legal status of the master's son.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

27] Who among the following rulers advised his subjects through this inscription? [2020]

"Whosoever praises his religious sect or blames other sects out of excessive devotion to his own sect, with the view of glorifying his own sect, he rather injures his own sect very severely."

- a) Ashoka b) Samudragupta
c) Harshavardhana d) Krishnadeva Raya

28] Consider the following statements: [2003]

1. The last Mauryan ruler, Brihadratha was assassinated by his commander in chief, Pushyamitra Sunga.
2. The last Sunga king, Devabhuti was assassinated by his Brahmana minister Vasudeva Kanva who usurped the throne
3. The last ruler of the Kanva dynasty was deposed by the Andhras.

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 b) Only 2
c) Only 3 d) 1, 2 and 3

29] Which one of the following dynasties was ruling over North India at the time of Alexander's invasion? [2000]

- a) Nanda b) Maurya
c) Sunga d) Kanva

30] Assertion (A): Ashoka annexed Kalinga to the Mauryan Empire.

Reason (R): Kalinga controlled the land and sea routes to South India. [2000]

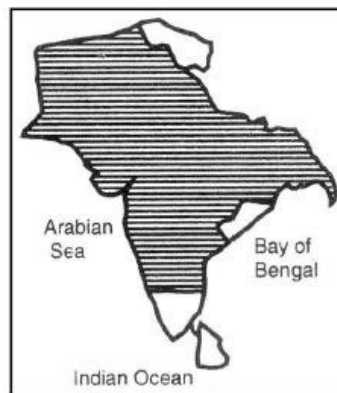
- a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b) Both A and R are true, but R is not a correct explanation of A
c) A is true, but R is false
d) A is false, but R is true

31] Assertion (A): According to Asoka's edicts social harmony among the people was more important than religious devotion.

Reason (R): He spread ideas of equity instead of promotion of religion. [1998]

- a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b) Both A and R are true, but R is NOT a correct explanation of A
c) A is true, but R is false
d) A is false, but R is true

32] The given map relates to: [1998]



- a) Kaniska at the time of his death
b) Samudragupta after the close of his South Indian campaign
c) Asoka towards close of his reign
d) Empire of Thaneshwar on the eve of Harsha's accession

6) Post Mauryan Period: Greek, Saka, Parthian and Kushan Invasions, Satavahanas in Deccan

33] With reference to the invaders in ancient India, which one of the following is the correct chronological order? [2006]

- a) Greeks . Sakas . Kushans
b) Greeks . Kushans . Sakas
c) Sakas . Greeks . Kushans
d) Sakas . Kushans . Greeks

34] From the third century AD, when the Hun invasion ended the Roman Empire, the Indian merchants relied more and more on the: [1999]

- a) African trade
b) West European trade
c) South East Asian trade
d) Middle Eastern trade

35] The Indo-Greek kingdom set up in north Afghanistan in the beginning of the second century BC was: [1999]

- a) Bactria b) Scythia
c) Zedrasia d) Aria

36] Many of the Greeks, Kushanas and Shakas embraced Buddhism rather than Hinduism because: [1998]

- a) Buddhism was in the ascendant at that time
- b) They had renounced the policy of war and violence
- c) Caste-ridden Hinduism did not attract them
- d) Buddhism provided easier access to Indian society

37] What is the correct chronological order in which the following appeared in India? [1998]

- I. Gold coins
- II. Punchmarked silver coins
- III. Iron plough
- IV. Urban culture

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| a) III, IV, I, II | b) III, IV, II, I |
| c) IV, III, I, II | d) IV, III, II, I |

7) Guptas and Vakatakas

38] With reference to the history of India, the terms 'kulyavapa' and 'dronavapa' denote: [2020]

- a) Measurement of land
- b) Coins of different monetary value
- c) Classification of urban land
- d) Religious rituals

39] With reference to the period of Gupta dynasty in ancient India, the towns Ghantasala, Kadura and Chaul were known as: [2020]

- a) Ports handling foreign trade
- b) Capitals of powerful kingdoms
- c) Places of exquisite stone art and architecture
- d) Important of Buddhist pilgrimage centres

40] With reference to forced labour (Vishti) in India during the Gupta period, which one of the following statements is correct? [2019]

- a) It was considered a source of income for the State, a sort of tax paid by the people.
- b) It was totally absent in the Madhya Pradesh and Kathiawar regions of the Gupta Empire.
- c) The forced labourer was entitled to weekly wages.

d) The eldest son of the labourer was sent as the forced labourer.

41] With reference to the guilds (Shreni) of ancient India that played a very important role in the country's economy, which of the following statements is/are correct? [2012]

- 1. Every guild was registered with the central authority of the State and the king was the chief administrative authority on them.
- 2. The wages, rules of work, standards and prices were fixed by the guild.
- 3. The guild had judicial powers over its own members.

Choose the correct option:

- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| a) 1 & 2 Only | b) 3 Only |
| c) 2 & 3 Only | d) 1, 2, & 3 |

42] Consider the following statements: [2004]

- 1. The Chinese pilgrim Fa Hien attended the fourth Great Buddhist Council held by Kanishka.
- 2. The Chinese pilgrim Huan Tsang met Harsha and found him to be antagonistic to Buddhism.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|-----------------|--------------------|
| a) 1 only | b) 2 only |
| c) Both 1 and 2 | d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

43] Assertion (A): The origin of the feudal system in ancient India can be traced to military campaigns.

Reason (R): There was considerable expansion of the feudal system during the Gupta period. [2000]

- a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- b) Both A and R are true, but R is not a correct explanation of A
- c) A is true, but R is false
- d) A is false, but R is true

44] Which one of the following ports handled the north Indian trade during the Gupta period? [1999]

- | | |
|---------------|-----------|
| a) Tamralipti | b) Broach |
| c) Kalyan | d) Cambay |

45] The silver coins issued by the Guptas were called: [1997]

- a) Rupaka b) Karshapana
- c) Dinara d) Pana

46] Who among the following is known for his work on medicine during the Gupta period? [1996]

- a) Saumilla b) Sudraka
- c) Shaunaka d) Susruta

47] In Sanskrit plays written during the Gupta Period women and sudras speak: [1995]

- a) Sanskrit b) Prakrit
- c) Pali d) Sauraseni

8) Era of King Harsha

48] From the decline of Guptas until the rise of Harshavardhana in the early seventh century, which of the following kingdoms were holding power in Northern India? [2021]

- 1) The Guptas of Magadha
- 2) The Paramaras of Malwa
- 3) The Pushyabhutis of Thanesar
- 4) The Maukharis of Kanauj
- 5) The Yadavas of Devagiri
- 6) The Maitrakas of Valabhi

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1, 2 and 5 b) 1, 3, 4 and 6
- c) 2, 3 and 4 d) 5 and 6

49] Emperor Harsha's southward march was stopped on the Narmada River by: [2003]

- a) Pulakesin I b) Pulakesin II
- c) Vikramaditya I d) Vikramaditya II

50] Assertion (A): Harshavardhana convened the Prayag Assembly.

Reason (R): He wanted to popularise only the Mahayana form of Buddhism. [2001]

- a) Both A and R are individually true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- b) Both A and R are individually true, but R is NOT a correct explanation of A
- c) A is true, but R is false
- d) A is false, but R is true

9) History of South India

51] Who among the following led a successful military campaign against the kingdom of Srivijaya, the powerful maritime State, which ruled the Malay Peninsula, Sumatra, Java and the neighbouring islands? [2025]

- a) Amoghavarsha (Rashtrakuta)
- b) Prataparudra (Kakatiya)
- c) Rajendra I (Chola)
- d) Vishnuvardhana (Hoysala)

52] Who among the following rulers in ancient India had assumed the titles 'Mattavilasa', 'Vichitrachitta' and 'Gunabhara'? [2025]

- a) Mahendravarman I b) Simhavishnu
- c) Narasimhavarman I d) Simhavarman

53] In the context of the history of India, consider the following pairs: [2016]

Term:	Description
1) Eripatti:	Land, revenue from which was set apart for the maintenance of the village tank
2) Taniyurs:	Villages donated to a single Brahmin or a group of Brahmins
3) Ghatikas:	Colleges generally attached to the temples

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 d) 1 and 3

54] India maintained its early cultural contacts and trade links with southeast Asia across the bay of Bengal. For this pre-eminence of the early maritime history of the Bay of Bengal, which of the following could be the most convincing explanation/explanations? [2011]

- a) As compared to other countries, India had better ship-building technology in ancient and medieval times.

Answers:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
b	d	d	c	c	b	c	b	a	c	c	c	c	c	c	b	a	c	c	a

21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40
c	d	c	c	b	b	a	d	a	a	a	c	a	c	a	d	d	a	a	a

41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60
c	d	b	a	a	d	b	b	b	c	c	a	d	c	c	c	c	a	d	b

61	62	63
c	c	b

B) Architecture

Architecture of Ancient India, Sculpture, Pottery, Coins, UNESCO World Heritage Sites.

Q 1] Consider the following information: [2024]

Archaeological Site - State - Description

1. Chandraketugarh - Odisha - Trading Port town
2. Inamgaon- Maharashtra - Chalcolithic site
3. Mangadu- Kerala- Megalithic site
4. Salihundam - Andhra Pradesh - Rock-cut cave shrines

In which of the above rows is the given information correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 b) 2 and 3
c) 3 and 4 d) 1 and 4

2] Consider the following pairs: [2023]

Site : Well known for

1. Besnagar : Shaivite cave shrine
2. Bhaja : Buddhist cave shrine
3. Sittanavasal: Jain cave shrine

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- a) Only one b) Only two
c) All three d) None

3] With reference to the Indian History, Alexander Rea, A.H. Longhurst, Robert Sewell, James Burgess and Walter Elliot were associated with? [2023]

- a) Archaeological excavations
b) Establishment of English Press in Colonial India

- c) Establishment of Churches in Princely States
d) Construction of railways in Colonial India

4] With reference to ancient India, consider the following statements: [2023]

1. The concept of Stupa is Buddhist in origin.
2. Stupa was generally a repository of relics.
3. Stupa was a votive and commemorative structure in Buddhist tradition.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- a) Only one b) Only two
c) All three d) None

5] Consider the following pairs: [2022]

Site of Ashoka's major rock edicts: Location

1. Dhauli Odisha
2. Erragudi Andhra Pradesh
3. Jaugada Madhya Pradesh
4. Kalsi Karnataka

How many pairs given above are correctly matched?

- a) Only one pair b) Only two pairs
c) Only three pairs d) All four pairs

6] The Prime Minister recently inaugurated the new Circuit House near Somnath Temple at Veraval. Which of the following statements are correct regarding Somnath Temple? [2022]

1. Somnath Temple is one of the Jyotirlinga shrines.
2. A description of Somnath Temple was given by Al-Biruni.
3. Pran Pratishtha of Somnath Temple (installation of the present day temple) was done by President S. Radhakrishnan.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| a) 1 and 2 only | b) 2 and 3 only |
| c) 1 and 3 only | d) 1, 2 and 3 |

7] Which one of the following statements is correct? [2021]

- a) Ajanta Caves lie in the gorge of the Waghora river.
- b) Sanchi Stupa lies in the gorge of the Chambal river.
- c) Pandu-Lena Cave Shrines lie in the gorge of the Narmada river.
- d) Amaravati Stupa lies in the gorge of the Godavari river.

8] With reference to Chausath Yogini Temple situated near Morena, consider the following statements: [2021]

- 1) It is a circular temple built during the reign of Kachchhapaghata Dynasty.
- 2) It is the only circular temple built in India.
- 3) It was meant to promote the Vaishnava cult in the region.
- 4) Its design has given rise to a popular belief that it was the inspiration behind the Indian Parliament building.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- | | |
|------------|-----------------|
| a) 1 and 2 | b) 2 and 3 only |
| c) 1 and 4 | d) 2, 3 and 4 |

9] Which one of the following ancient towns is well-known for its elaborate system of water harvesting and management by building a series of dams and channelizing water into connected reservoirs? [2021]

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| a) Dholavira | b) Kalibangan |
| c) Rakhigarhi | d) Ropar |

10] In which of the following relief sculpture inscriptions is 'Ranyo Ashoka' (King Ashoka) mentioned along with the stone portrait of Ashoka? [2019]

- | | |
|-----------------|-------------|
| a) Kanganahalli | b) Sanchi |
| c) Shahbazgarhi | d) Sohgauna |

11] The painting of Bodhisattva Padmapani is one of the most famous and oft-illustrated paintings at: [2017]

- | | |
|-----------|-----------|
| a) Ajanta | b) Badami |
| c) Bagh | d) Ellora |

12] Which of the following is/are famous for Sun temples? [2017]

- | | | |
|---------------|----------------|----------------|
| 1. Arasavalli | 2. Amarakantak | 3. Omkareshwar |
|---------------|----------------|----------------|

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| a) 1 only | b) 2 and 3 only |
| c) 1 and 3 only | d) 1, 2 and 3 |

13] Who of the following had first deciphered the edicts of Emperor Ashoka? [2016]

- | | |
|-----------------|------------------|
| a) Georg Bihler | b) James Prinsep |
| c) Max Muller | d) William Jones |

14] What is/are common to the two historical places known as Ajanta and Mahabalipuram? [2016]

1. Both were built in the same period.
2. Both belong to the same religious denomination.
3. Both have rock-cut monuments.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- | | |
|-----------------|--------------------|
| a) 1 and 2 only | b) 3 only |
| c) 1 and 3 only | d) None is correct |

15] With reference to art and archaeological history of India, which one among the following was made earliest? [2015]

- a) Lingaraja Temple at Bhubaneswar
- b) Rock-cut Elephant at Dhauri
- c) Rock-cut Monuments at Mahabalipuram
- d) Varaha Image at Udayagiri

16] With reference to the Indian history of art and culture, consider the following pairs: [2014]

Famous work of sculpture: **Site**

1. A grand image of Buddha's Mahaparinirvana with numerous celestial musicians above and the sorrowful figures of his followers below:

Ajanta

2. A huge image of Varaha Avatar (boar incarnation) of Vishnu, as he rescues Goddess Earth from the deep and chaotic waters, sculpted on rock: **Mount Abu**

3. "Arjuna's Penance"/ "Descent of Ganga" sculpted on the surface of huge boulder:

Mamallapuram

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only b) 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

17] With reference to Buddhist history, tradition and culture in India, consider the following pairs: [2014]

Famous Shrine: **Location**

1. Tabo monastery and temple complex: Spiti Valley

2. Lhotsava Lhakhang: **Zaskar Valley**

3. Alchi Temple Complex: **Ladakh**

Which of the above pairs given is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

18] With reference to the cultural history of India, the term 'Panchayatan' refers to: [2014]

- a) An assembly of village elders
b) A religious sect
c) A style of temple construction
d) An administrative functionary

19] Some Buddhist rock-cut caves are called Chaityas, while the others are called Viharas. What is the difference between the two? [2013]

- a) Vihara is a place of worship, while Chaitya is the dwelling place of the monks
b) Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the dwelling place of the monks

c) Chaitya is the stupa at the far end of the cave, while Vihara is the hall axial to it

d) There is no material difference between the two

20] With reference to the history of Indian rock-cut architecture, consider the following statements: [2013]

1. The caves at Badami are the oldest Surviving rock-cut caves in India.

2. The Barabar rock-cut caves were originally made for Ajivikas by Emperor Chandragupta Maurya.

3. At Ellora, caves were made for different faiths.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
c) 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

21] Consider the following historical places: [2013]

1. Ajanta caves

2. Lepakshi temple

3. Sanchi stupa

Which of the above places is/ are also known for mural paintings?

- a) 1 only b) 1 and 2 only
c) 1, 2 and 3 d) None

22] The Nagara, the Dravida and the Vesara are the: [2012]

- a) Three main racial groups of the Indian subcontinent
b) Three main linguistic divisions into which the languages of India can be classified
c) Three main styles of Indian temple architecture
d) Three main musical Gharanas prevalent in India

23] There are only two known examples of cave paintings of the Gupta period in ancient India. One of these is paintings of Ajanta Caves. Where is the other surviving example of Gupta paintings? [2010]

- a) Bagh Caves b) Ellora Caves
c) Lomas Rishi cave d) Nasik caves

24] Where is the famous Virupaksha temple located? [2009]

- a) Bhadrachalam b) Chidambaram
c) Hampi d) Srikalahasti

25] In which State is the Buddhist site Tabo Monastery located? [2009]

- a) Arunachal Pradesh b) Himachal Pradesh
c) Sikkim d) Uttarakhand

26] Match List with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists: [2009]

(Famous Temple)	(State)
A. Vidyashankara	1. Andhra Pradesh
B. Rajarani Temple	2. Karnataka
C. Kandariya Mahadeo	3. Madhya Pradesh
D. Bhimeswara temple	4. Orissa

- | | A | B | C | D |
|----|---|---|---|---|
| a) | 2 | 4 | 3 | 1 |
| b) | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 |
| c) | 1 | 4 | 3 | 2 |
| d) | 1 | 3 | 4 | 2 |

27] Near Which one of the following cities are Palitana Temples located? [2009]

- a) Bhavnagar b) Mount Abu
c) Nasik d) Ujjain

28] Where is the famous Vijaya Vitla temple having its 56 carved pillars emitting musical notes located? [2008]

- a) Belur b) Bhadrachalam
c) Hampi d) Srirangam

29] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists: [2006]

(Place of archaeological monument)	List 2 (State)
A. Sisupalgarh	1. Assam
B. Piprahwa	2. Manipur
C. Goalpara	3. Orissa
D. Bishnupur	4. Uttar Pradesh

- | | A | B | C | D |
|----|---|---|---|---|
| a) | 2 | 4 | 1 | 3 |
| b) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| c) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| d) | 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |

30] Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched? [2006]

- a) Vikramshila Monastery: Uttar Pradesh
b) Hemkund Gurudwara: Himachal Pradesh
c) Udayagiri Caves: Maharashtra
d) Amaravati Buddhist Stupa: Andhra Pradesh

31] Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched? [2006]

- | Monastery | State |
|-----------------------|-------------------|
| a) Dhankar Monastery- | Himachal Pradesh |
| b) Rumtek Monastery- | Sikkim |
| c) Tabo Monastery- | Himachal Pradesh |
| d) Kye Monastery- | Arunachal Pradesh |

32] The initial design and construction of which massive temple took place during the reign of Suryavarman II? [2006]

- a) Sri Mariamman Temple b) Angkor Vat
c) Batu Caves Temple d) Kamakhya Temple

33] The Allahabad Pillar inscription is associated with which one of the following? [2006]

- a) Mahapadma Nanda
b) Chandragupta Maurya
c) Ashoka
d) Samudragupta

34] Consider the following sites/monuments: [2005]

1. Champaner- Pavagadh Archaeological Park
2. Chhatrapati Shivaji Railway Station, Mumbai
3. Mamallapuram
4. Sun Temple (Konark Temple)

Which of the above are included in the World Heritage List of UNESCO?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 b) 1,3 and 4
c) 2 and 4 d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

35] The Archaeological Survey of India is an attached office of the Department / Ministry of: [2004]

- a) Culture
- b) Tourism
- c) Science and Technology
- d) Human Resource Development

36] Which one of the following statements is incorrect? [2002]

- a) The statue of Gomateshwara at Sravanabelagola represents the last Tirthankara of Jains
- b) India's largest Buddhist monastery is in Arunachal Pradesh
- c) The Khajuraho temples were built under Chandela Kings
- d) The Hoysalesvara temple is dedicated to Siva

37] In which one of the following cities is the Lingaraja Temple located? [2001]

- a) Bhubaneswar b) Bijapur
- c) Kolkata d) Shravanabelagola

38] Hoysala monuments are found in: [2001]

- a) Hampi and Hospet
- b) Halebid and Belur
- c) Mysore and Bangalore
- d) Sringeri and Dharwar

39] Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched? [2001]

- | | |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| a) Harappan Civilisation- | Painted Grey Ware |
| b) The Kushans- | Gandhara School of Art |
| c) The Mughals- | Ajanta Paintings |
| d) The Marathas- | Pahari School of Painting |

40] Assertion (A): The Gandhara School of art bears the mark of Hellenistic influence.

Reason (R): Hinayana form was influenced by that art. [1998]

- a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A

b) Both A and R are true, but R is NOT a correct explanation of A

c) A is true, but R is false

d) A is false, but R is true

41] Which one of the following ancient Indian records is the earliest royal order to preserve foodgrains to be utilised during the crises in the country? [1998]

- a) Sohgaura Copperplate
- b) Rummindei pillar edict of Asoka
- c) Prayaga Prasasti
- d) Mehrauli Pillar inscription of Chandra

42] The Asokan major rock edicts which tell us about the Sangam Kingdom include rock edicts: [1998]

- | | |
|----------------|---------------|
| a) I and X | b) I and XI |
| c) II and XIII | d) II and XIV |

43] Which one of the following statements regarding Asokan stone pillars is incorrect? [1997]

- a) These are highly polished
- b) These are monolithic
- c) The shaft of pillars is tapering in shape
- d) These are parts of architectural structures

44] Which one of the following edicts mentions the personal name of Asoka? [1997]

- | | |
|--------------------------|--------------|
| a) Kalsi | b) Rummindei |
| c) Special Kalinga Edict | d) Maski |

45] Which one of the following sculptures invariably used green schist as the medium? [1996]

- a) Maurya sculptures
- b) Mathura sculptures
- c) Bharhut sculptures
- d) Gandhara sculptures.

46] The name by which Asoka is generally referred to in his inscriptions is: [1995]

- | | |
|----------------|---------------|
| a) Chakravarti | b) Dharmadeva |
| c) Dharmakirti | d) Priyadasi |

47] The Nagara, the Dravida and the Vesara are: [1995]

- a) The three main racial groups of the Indian subcontinent
- b) The three main linguistic divisions into which the languages of India can be classified
- c) The three main styles of Indian temple architecture

d) The three main musical gharanas prevalent in India

48] Bronze icons of Nataraja cast during the Chola period invariably show the deity with: [1995]

- a) Eight hands
- b) Six hands
- c) Four hands
- d) Two hands

Answers:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
b	b	a	b	b	a	a	c	a	a	a	a	b	b	b	c	c	c	b	c

21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40
b	c	a	c	b	a	a	c	c	d	d	b	d	d	a	a	a	b	b	c

41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48
a	c	d	d	c	d	c	c

C) Literature

Literature in Ancient India

Q 1] Fa-hien (Faxian), the Chinese pilgrim, travelled to India during the reign of: [2025]

- a) Samudragupta
- b) Chandragupta II
- c) Kumaragupta I
- d) Skandagupta

2] Which one of the following is a work attributed to playwright Bhasa? [2024]

- a) Kavyalankara
- b) Natyashastra
- c) Madhyama-vyayoga
- d) Mahabhashya

3] Consider the following statements: [2024]

1. There are no parables in Upanishads.
2. Upanishads were composed earlier than the Puranas.

of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

4] Sanghabhuti, an Indian Buddhist monk, who travelled to China at the end of the fourth century AD, was the author of a commentary on: [2024]

- a) Prajnaparamita Sutra
- b) Visuddhimagga
- c) Sarvastivada Vinaya
- d) Lalitavistara

5] With reference to ancient Indian History, consider the following pairs: [2023]

Literary Work : Author

1. Devichandragupta : Bilhana
2. Hammira-Mahakavya : Nayachandra Suri
3. Milinda-panha : Nagarjuna
4. Nitivakyamrita : Somadeva Suri

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- a) Only one
- b) Only two
- c) Only three
- d) All four

6] Which one of the following explains the practice of 'Vattakirutal' as mentioned in the Sangam poems? [2023]

- a) Kings employing women bodyguards
- b) Learned persons assembling in royal courts to discuss religious and philosophical matters.
- c) Young girls keeping watch over agricultural fields and driving away birds and animals.
- d) A king defeated in a battle committing ritual suicide by starving himself to death.

7] Which one of the following statements about Sangam literature in ancient South India is correct? [2022]

- a) Sangam poems are devoid of any reference to material culture.
- b) The social classification of Varna was known to Sangam poets.
- c) Sangam poems have no references to warrior ethic.
- d) Sangam literature refers to magical forces as irrational.

8] With reference to the history of ancient India Bhavabhuti Hastimalla and Kshemeshvara were famous: [2021]

- a) Jain monks b) Playwrights
- c) Temple architects d) Philosophers

9] With reference to the scholars/litterateurs of ancient India, consider the following statements: [2020]

- 1. Panini is associated with Pushyamitra
 - 2. Amarasimha is associated with Harshavardhana
 - 3. Kalidasa is associated with Chandra Gupta-II
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

10] Which one of the following foreign travellers elaborately discussed about Diamonds and diamond mines in India? [2018]

- a) Francois Bernier
- b) Jean-Baptiste Tavernier
- c) Jean de Thevenot
- d) Abbe Barthelemy Carre

11] Which one of the following books of ancient India has the love story of the son of the founder of Sunga dynasty? [2016]

- a) Swapnavasavadatta b) Malavikagnimitra
- c) Meghadoota d) Ratnavali

12] The Chinese traveller Yuan Chwang (Hiuen Tsang) who visited India recorded the general conditions and culture of India at that time. In this context, which of the following statements is/are correct? [2013]

- 1. The roads and river-routes were completely immune from robbery.
- 2. As regards punishment for offences, ordeals by fire, water and poison were the instruments for determining the innocence or guilt of a person.
- 3. The tradesmen had to play duties at ferries and barrier stations.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

13] Recently, the manuscripts of which one of the following have been included in the UNESCO's Memory of World Register? [2008]

- a) Abhidhamma Pitaka b) Mahabharata
- c) Ramayana d) Rig-Veda

14] Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells? [2004]

- a) Rigveda b) Yajurveda
- c) Atharvaveda d) Samaveda

15] 'Mrichchhakatika' an ancient Indian book written by Shudraka deals with: [2003]

- a) The love affair of a rich merchant with the daughter of a courtesan
- b) The victory of Chandragupta II over the Shaka Kshatrapas of western India
- c) The military expeditions and exploits of Samudragupta
- d) The love affair between a Gupta King and a princess of Kamarupa

16] The ancient Indian play Mudrarakshasa of Visakhadatta has its subject on: [2002]

- a) A conflict between Gods and Demons of ancient Hindu lore
- b) A romantic story of an Aryan prince and a tribal woman
- c) The story of the power struggle between two Aryan tribes
- d) The court intrigues at the time of Chandragupta Maurya

17] Assertion (A): The Aham and Puram poems of the Padinen Kilukanakku group formed a continuation of the Sangam composition.

Reason (R): They were included under the Post Sangam works as against the Sangam works proper. [2000]

- a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- b) Both A and R are true, but R is not a correct explanation of A
- c) A is true, but R is false
- d) A is false, but R is true

18] The following persons came to India at one time or another: [1999]

- | | |
|-------------------|-----------------|
| I. Fa Hien | II. Itsing |
| III. Megasthenese | IV. Hieun Tsang |
- The correct chronological sequence of their visits is:
- a) III, I, II, IV
 - b) III, I, IV, II
 - c) I, III, II, IV
 - d) I, III, IV, II

19] Which of the following pairs are correctly matched? [1998]

- I. Mrichchakatikam — Shudraka
- II. Buddhacharita — Vasuvandhu
- III. Mudrarakshasha — Vishakhadatta
- IV. Harshacharita — Banabhatta

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) I, II, III and IV
- b) I, III and IV
- c) I and IV
- d) II and III

20] Which one of the following pairs of composers in different languages and their works on the Mahabharata theme is correctly matched? [1997]

- a) Sarladasa — Bengali
- b) Kasirama — Oriya
- c) Tikkana — Marathi
- d) Pampa — Kannada

21] Which one of the following scripts of ancient India was written from right to left? [1997]

- a) Brahmi
- b) Nandnagari
- c) Sharada
- d) Kharoshti

22] The famous dialogue between, Nachiketa and Yama is mentioned in the: [1997]

- a) Chhandogyopanishad
- b) Mundakopanishad
- c) Kathopanishad
- d) Kenopanishad

23] Milindapanho is in the form of a dialogue between the King Menander and the Buddhist monk: [1997]

- a) Nagasena
- b) Nagarjuna
- c) Nagabhatta
- d) Kumarilabhatta

24] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the lists: [1997]

- | | |
|------------------|--------------------------|
| List I (Author) | List II (Text) |
| I. Varahamihira | A) Prabandha Chintamani |
| II. Visakhadatta | B) Mrchchhakatikam |
| III. Sudraka | C) BrhatSamhita |
| IV. Bilhana | D) Devi Chandragupta |
| | E) Vikramankadevacharita |

- a) IC, IID, IIIE, IVB
- b) IC, IID, IIIB, IVE
- c) IE, IIC, IIID, IVA
- d) IA, IIC, IIIE, IVB

25] Prem Vatika, poems on the life of Krishna, was composed by: [1996]

- a) Bihari
- b) Surdas
- c) Raskhan
- d) Kabir

26] The river most mentioned in early Vedic literature is: [1996]

- a) Sindhu b) Sutudri
c) Sarasvati d) Ganga

27] The term apabhramsa was used in medieval Sanskrit texts to denote: [1996]

- a) Outcastes among the Rajputs
b) Deviations from Vedic rituals
c) Early forms of some of the modern Indian languages
d) NonSanskrit verse metres

28] Which one of the following texts of ancient India allows divorce to a wife deserted by her husband? [1996]

- a) Kamasutra b) Manavadharmashastra
c) Sukra Nitisara d) Arthashastra

29] Who among the following was a Brahmadini who composed some hymns of the Vedas? [1995]

- a) Lopamudra b) Gargi
c) Leelavati d) Savitri

30] The term 'Yavanapriya', mentioned in ancient Sanskrit texts, denoted: [1995]

- a) A fine variety of Indian muslin
b) Ivory
c) Damsels sent to the Greek court for dance performance
d) Pepper

Answers:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
b	c	b	c	b	d	b	b	c	b	b	b	d	c	a	d	a	b	b	d

21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
d	c	a	b	c	a	c	d	a	d

D) Religion and Philosophy

Buddhism, Jainism, Hinduism, Islam and other religions, Philosophy

Q 1] With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets? [2024]

1. Nayaputta
2. Shakyamuni
3. Tathagata

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1, 2 and 3
d) None of the above are epithets of Gautama Buddha

2] "Souls are not only the property of animal and plant life, but also of rocks, running water and many other natural objects not looked on as living by other religious sects." [2023]

The above statement reflects one of the core beliefs of which one of the following religious sects of ancient India?

- a) Buddhism b) Jainism
c) Shaivism d) Vaishnavism

3] In which one of the following regions was Dhanyakataka, which flourished as a prominent Buddhist center under the Mahasanghikas, located? [2023]

- a) Andhra b) Gandhara

c) Kalinga

d) Magadha

4] The world's second tallest statue in sitting pose of Ramanuja was inaugurated by the Prime Minister of India at Hyderabad recently. Which one of the following statements correctly represents the teachings of Ramanuja? [2022]

a) The best means of salvation was devotion.

b) Vedas are eternal, self-existent and wholly authoritative.

c) Logical arguments were essential means for the highest bliss.

d) Salvation was to be obtained through meditation.

5] With reference to Indian history, consider the following texts: [2022]

1. Nettipakarana

2. Parishishtaparvan

3. Avadanashataka

4. Trishashtilakshana Mahapurana

Which of the above are Jaina texts?

a) 1, 2 and 3

b) 2 and 4 only

c) 1, 3 and 4

d) 2, 3 and 4

6] With reference to Indian history, consider the following pairs: [2022]

Historical person

Known as

1. Aryadeva

Jaina Scholar

2. Dignaga

Buddhist Scholar

3. Nathamuni

Vaishnava scholar

How many pairs given above are correctly matched?

a) None of the pairs

b) Only one pair

c) Only two pairs

d) All three pairs

7] With reference to the history of ancient India, which of the following statements is/are correct? [2021]

1. Mitakshara was the civil law for upper castes and Dayabhaga was the civil law for lower castes.

2. In the Mitakshara system, the sons can claim right to the property during the lifetime of the father, whereas in the Dayabhaga system, it is only after the death of the father that the sons can claim right to the property.

3. The Mitakshara system deals with the matters related to the property held by male members only of a family, whereas the Dayabhaga system deals with the matters related to the property held by both male and female members of a family.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

a) 1 and 2

b) 2 only

c) 1 and 3

d) 3 only

8] With reference to the cultural history of India, which one of the following is the correct description of the term 'paramitas'? [2020]

a) The earliest Dharmashastra texts written in aphoristic (sutra) style

b) Philosophical schools that did not accept the authority of Vedas

c) Perfections whose attainment led to the Bodhisattva path

d) Powerful merchant guilds of early medieval South India

9] With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements: [2020]

1. Sthaviravadins belong to Mahayana Buddhism.

2. Lokottaravadin sect was an offshoot of Mahasanghika sect of Buddhism.

3. The deification of Buddha by Mahasanghikas fostered Mahayana Buddhism.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) 1 and 2 only

b) 2 and 3 only

c) 3 only

d) 1, 2 and 3

10] With reference to the cultural history of India, consider the following pairs: [2020]

1. Parivrajaka — Renunciant and Wanderer

2. Shramana — Priest with a high status

3. Upasaka — Lay follower of Buddhism

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

a) 1 and 2 only

b) 1 and 3 only

c) 2 and 3 only

d) 1, 2 and 3

11] Consider the following: [2019]

1) Deification of the Buddha

2) Treading the path of Bodhisattvas

3) Image worship and rituals

Which of the above is/are the feature/ features of Mahayana Buddhism?

- a) 1 only b) 1 and 2 only
c) 2 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

12] With reference to the religious practices in India, the "Sthanakvasi" sect belongs to: [2018]

- a) Buddhism b) Jainism
c) Vaishnavism d) Shaivism

13] With reference to the Indian History, who among the following is a future Buddha, yet to come to save the world? [2018]

- a) Avalokiteshvara b) Lokeshvara
c) Maitreya d) Padmapani

14] With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements: [2017]

1. Sautrantika and Sammitiya were the sects of Jainism.
2. Sarvastivadin held that the constituents of phenomena were not wholly momentary, but existed forever in a latent form.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2 d) Neither 1 nor 2

15] With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements: [2016]

- 1) The concept of Bodhisattva is central to Hinayana sect of Buddhism.
- 2) Bodhisattva is a compassionate one on his way to enlightenment.
- 3) Bodhisattva delays achieving his own salvation to help all sentient beings on their path to it.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
c) 2 only d) 1, 2 and 3

16] With reference to the cultural history of India, the memorizing of chronicles, dynastic histories and Epictales was the profession of who of the following? [2016]

- a) Shramana b) Parivraajaka

c) Agrahaarika

d) Maagadha

17] Consider the following statements: [2014]

1. 'Bijak' is a composition of the teachings of Saint Dadu Dayal.
2. The Philosophy of Pushti Marg was propounded by Madhvacharya.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2 d) Neither 1 nor 2

18] Which one of the following pairs does not form part of the six systems of Indian Philosophy? [2014]

- a) Mimamsa and Vedanta
b) Nyaya and Vaisheshika
c) Lokayata and Kapalika
d) Sankhya and Yoga

19] With reference to the history of philosophical thought in India, consider the following statements regarding Sankhya school? [2013]

1. Sankhya does not accept the theory of rebirth or transmigration of soul.
2. Sankhya holds that it is the self-knowledge that leads to liberation and not any exterior influence or agent.

Which of the statements are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2 d) Neither 1 nor 2

20] Which one of the following describes best the concept of Nirvana in Buddhism? [2013]

- a) The extinction of the flame of desire
b) The complete annihilation of self
c) A state of Bliss and rest
d) A mental stage beyond all comprehension

21] Which of the following statements is/are applicable to Jain doctrine? [2013]

1. The surest way of annihilating Karma is to practice penance.
 2. Every object, even the smallest particle has a soul.
 3. Karma is the bane of the soul and must be ended.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

22] Lord Buddha's image is sometimes shown with the hand gesture called 'Bhumisparsha Mudra'. It symbolizes: [2012]

- a) Buddha's calling of the Earth to watch over Mara and to prevent Mara from disturbing his meditation
b) Buddha's calling of the Earth to witness his purity and chastity despite the temptations of Mara
c) Buddha's reminder to his followers that they all arise from the Earth and finally dissolve into the Earth, and thus this life is transitory
d) Both the statements a) and b) are correct in this context

23] With reference to the history of ancient India, which of the following was/were common to both Buddhism and Jainism? [2012]

- 1) Avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment
2) Indifference to the authority of the Vedas
3) Denial of efficacy of rituals

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 & 3

24] The Jain philosophy holds that the world is created and maintained by? [2011]

- a) Universal law b) Universal truth
c) Universal faith d) Universal soul

25] With reference to ancient Jainism, which one of the following statements is correct? [2004]

- a) Jainism was spread in South India under the leadership of Sthalabahu.
b) The Jainas who remained under the leadership of Bhadrabahu were called Shvetambaras after the Council held at Pataliputra.
c) Jainism enjoyed the patronage of the Kalinga king Kharavela in the first century BC.
d) In the initial stage of Jainism, the Jainas worshipped images unlike Buddhists.

26] Which one of the following sequences indicates the correct chronological order? [2004]

- a) Shankaracharya-Ramanuja-Chaitanya
b) Ramanuja-Shankaracharya-Chaitanya
c) Ramanuja-Chaitanya-Shankaracharya
d) Shankaracharya-Chaitanya-Ramanuja

27] Consider the following statements: [2003]

1. Vardhamana Mahavira's mother was the daughter of Lichchhavi chief Chetaka.
2. Goutama Buddha's mother was a princess from the Koshalan dynasty.
3. Parshvanatha, the 23rd Tirthankara, belonged to Banaras.

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- a) Only 1 b) Only 2
c) 2 and 3 d) 1, 2 and 3

28] In ancient Indian Buddhist monasteries, a ceremony called Pavarana used to be held. It was the: [2003]

- a) Occasion to elect the Sanghaparinayaka and two speakers one on Dhamma and the other on Vinaya
b) Confession by monks of their offences committed during their stay in the monasteries during the rainy season
c) Ceremony of initiation of new person into the Buddhist Sangha in which the head is shaved and when yellow robes are offered
d) Gathering of Buddhist monks on the next day to the full moon day of Ashadha when they take up affixed abode for the next four months or rainy season

29] Who among the following presided over the Buddhist Council held during the reign of Kanishka at Kashmir? [2001]

- a) Parsva b) Nagarjuna
c) Sudraka d) Vasumitra

30] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists: [2001]

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------------|
| List I (Bhakti Saint) | List II (Profession) |
| I. Namdev | A) Barber |
| II. Kabir | B) Weaver |

- III. Ravidas C) Tailor
IV. Sena D) Cobbler

- a) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
b) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
c) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
d) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

31] Assertion (A): The emphasis of Jainism on non-violence (ahimsa) prevented agriculturalists from embracing Jainism.

Reason (R): Cultivation involved killing of insects and pests. [2000]

- a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b) Both A and R are true, but R is not a correct explanation of A
c) A is true, but R is false
d) A is false, but R is true

32] The concept of Eightfold path forms the theme of: [1998]

- a) Dipavamsa
b) Divyavadana
c) Mahaparinibban Sutta
d) Dharma Chakara Pravartana Sutta

33] In Mahayana Buddhism, the Bodhisattva Avalokitesvara was also known as: [1997]

- a) Vajrapani b) Manjusri
c) Padmapani d) Maitreya

34] Which one of the following is not a part of early Jaina literature? [1996]

- a) Therigatha b) Acarangasutra
c) Suttrakritanga d) Brihatkalpasutra

35] Which of the following were common to both Buddhism and Jainism? [1996]

- 1) Avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment.
2) Indifference to the authority of the Vedas
3) Denial of efficacy of rituals
4) Noninjury to animal life

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 b) 2, 3 and 4
c) 1, 3 and 4 d) 1 and 2

36] The Sufi saint who maintained that devotional music was one way of coming close to God was: [1996]

- a) Muinuddin Chishti
b) Baba Farid
c) Saiyid Muhammad Gesudaraz
d) Shah Alam Bukhari

37] Which one of the following was a Saiva sect in ancient India? [1996]

- a) Ajivika
b) Mattamayura
c) Mayamata
d) Isanasivagurudevapaddhati

38] According to ancient Indian cosmogonic ideas the sequential order of the cycle of four aeons (Yugas) is: [1996]

- a) Dvapara, Krita, Treta and Kali
b) Krita, Dvapara, Treta and Kali
c) Krita, Treta, Dvapara and Kali
d) Treta, Dvapara, Kali and Krita

39] According to the Mimamsa system of philosophy, liberation is possible by means of: [1995]

- a) Jnana b) Bhakti
c) Yoga d) Karma

40] The concept of Anuvrata was advocated by: [1995]

- a) Mahayana Buddhism
b) Hinayana Buddhism
c) Jainism
d) The Lokayata school

41] The word 'Hindu' as a reference to the people of Hind (India) was first used by: [1995]

- a) Greeks b) Romans
c) Chinese d) Arabs

Answers:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
b	b	a	a	b	c	b	c	b	b	d	b	c	b	b	d	d	c	b	a

21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40
d	b	b	a	c	a	c	b	d	b	a	d	c	a	b	a	b	c	d	c

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